



FUEL WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 11 SEPTEMBER 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Fuel conditions tightened this week as Saudi Arabia absorbed a refinery attack and maritime security pressure sharpened around the Strait of Hormuz and near the Bab el-Mandeb approach. At the same time, Russia's fuel crisis continued to constrain aviation refuelling and retail availability, while crude and jet fuel costs rose, lifting continuity pressure across shipping, aviation and road distribution.

FAST FACTS

BRENT CRUDE - ICE BRENT FRONT-MONTH

104.6 USD/bbl

+8.7% 7d

ICE Brent front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 11 Sep 2026

WTI CRUDE - NYMEX WTI FRONT-MONTH

100.0 USD/bbl

+9.4% 7d

NYMEX WTI front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 11 Sep 2026

JET FUEL

4.340 USD/gal

+5.4% 7d

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type · EIA / FRED

As of 9 Sep 2026

Reporting-period coverage

2026-09-05 to 2026-09-11

DISTINCT DEVELOPMENTS

17

Evidence-family-deduplicated

ACTIVE COUNTRIES

5

With an attributed development

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION

Insignificant		0
Low		7
Moderate		9
High		1
Extreme		0

DAILY INCIDENT TREND

05 Sep		1
06 Sep		0
07 Sep		2
08 Sep		3
09 Sep		4
10 Sep		1
11 Sep		6

AFFECTED COUNTRIES – DISTINCT DEVELOPMENT COUNT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	HIGHEST SEVERITY	SEVERITY DETAIL
Russia	4	LOW	Low 4
Pakistan	2	MODERATE	Moderate 2
India	1	LOW	Low 1
Iran	1	MODERATE	Moderate 1
Saudi Arabia	1	HIGH	High 1
Unattributed	8	MODERATE	Low 2 · Moderate 6

Coverage is limited to current-period Fuel-relevant records that passed the relevance and evidence-family gates; syndicated, commentary and follow-on coverage is not counted as a separate development. Country rows are ordered by development count, not ranked for impact, and this is not a full raw-ingest total.

JET FUEL PRICE TRAJECTORY

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel (USD/gal)

Latest 09 Sep: **4.34** USD/gal



U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel, 6 observations from 01 Sep to 09 Sep.

Jet fuel latest available 9 Sep 2026 (daily EIA U.S. Gulf Coast series, publication trails the crude close); Brent and WTI run to 11 Sep 2026 (the period end).

MARKET READ

Brent crude - ICE Brent front-month is rising against a undated reference with no date; WTI crude - NYMEX WTI front-month is rising against a undated reference with no date; Jet fuel is rising within the reporting period.

Brent is sitting around 104.61 USD/bbl and WTI around 100.05 USD/bbl, which puts the crude complex in elevated territory rather than a transient spike. The jet fuel series is rising within the reporting period, with the observed figure at 4.340 USD/gal on 9 Sep 2026 versus 4.130 on 8 Sep 2026 (+5.1%).

Some reporting-period benchmarks rose. If suppliers pass those increases through, they could affect freight rates, generator running costs, staff movement and supplier pricing.

SITUATION

The operating backdrop is tighter and more expensive. Brent crude rose to 104.61 USD/bbl by 2026-09-11, WTI climbed to 100.05 USD/bbl, and jet fuel rose to 4.34 USD/gal on 2026-09-09.

This window's reported conditions centre on a chokepoint threat, refinery disruption and shortage. The most immediate pressure sits around Saudi Arabia and adjacent maritime routes, with secondary strain from Russia's domestic fuel dislocation and wider concern over refined-product availability.

WHAT HAPPENED

On 5 September 2026, second wave of fuel crisis hits Russia with long lines and tighter sales limits - NV analysis.

On 7 September 2026 in Pakistan, global ship fuel shortage looms as war disruptions squeeze refinery output.

On 8 September 2026 in Saudi Arabia, refinery or terminal disruption curtailed regional product output.

On 8 September 2026, ship fuel shortage looms as refiners strained by war favour other products.

On 8 September 2026, Ukraine hits Saratov refinery Again as Russian fuel crisis deepens.

On 10 September 2026, two tankers Attacked on Omani route in Strait of Hormuz, Brent hits \$108.

On 11 September 2026 in the Red Sea, Houthi Rebels Seize Key Port City near Bab el-Mandeb Strait in new Attacks.

On 11 September 2026, one unit of Adani power plant shuts down, exacerbating load-shedding.

On 11 September 2026, sudden Shutdown of Multiple Power Plants worsens Load-Shedding.

On 11 September 2026, two vessels struck in Strait of Hormuz off Oman.

OPERATIONAL READ

The main themes right now are chokepoint pressure and tanker-route disruption; fuel shortages; refinery disruption and supply-side outage. Dependent fuel movement could be forced onto longer, costlier routes if the reported disruption constrains transit.

Watch for fresh advisories, vessel reroutes and any naval movement that signals escalation. Watch for rationing rules, allocation cuts to commercial users and convoy or queue management announcements. The reported operational themes are most visible in Russia, Saudi Arabia and Pakistan.

REGIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

Saudi Arabia is the clearest pressure point right now. Saudi Arabia was linked to Oil Surges Past \$99 After Saudi Refinery Attack. A confirmed loss of refinery output could tighten regional product balances and downstream pricing. Watch for restart timelines, force-majeure declarations and follow-on import announcements.

Pakistan is a secondary but credible concern. Forecourt and allocation pressure is the confirmed operational signal there. Forecourt shortages could put road transport, staff movement and generator runtime under immediate continuity pressure. Watch for rationing rules, allocation cuts to commercial users and convoy or queue management announcements.

WHAT MATTERS

The main continuity risk is not a single local outage but the combination of higher input costs and stress at key maritime and refining nodes. Pressure around Saudi Arabia and the Strait of Hormuz can feed quickly into freight costs, marine fuel availability and schedule reliability, especially where voyages depend on Gulf transits or tightly timed bunkering.

Russia adds a separate but practical aviation and road-fuel concern. Airport refuelling restrictions, tighter sales limits and long queues point to possible disruption to domestic flight planning, onward ground transport and local resupply. Rising jet fuel prices in India reinforce the cost side for air travel even where no physical shortage is reported.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Review voyage exposure to the Strait of Hormuz and the Bab el-Mandeb approach.
- Reconfirm bunker and fuel uplift plans at ports linked to Gulf transits.
- Build extra time into flight schedules and ground movements connected to Russia.
- Check alternate refuelling options for aviation routings affected by Russian airport restrictions.
- Refresh cost assumptions for air travel, marine fuel and road distribution.
- Update site and travel notices where load-shedding may disrupt local movement or power continuity.

WATCH NEXT

- a confirmed change in transit availability for road fuel distribution in Saudi Arabia.
- Follow-up confirmation for Second wave of fuel crisis hits Russia with long lines and tighter sales limits - NV analysis.
- Follow-up confirmation for Houthi Rebels Seize Key Port City Near Bab el-Mandeb Strait in New Attacks.
- Follow-up confirmation for Two Tankers Attacked on Omani Route in Strait of Hormuz, Brent Hits \$108.

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level is High. The most likely disruption is further cost and continuity pressure around Saudi-linked refining and the Gulf maritime chokepoint, with a separate but real risk of aviation and road-fuel friction inside Russia. Prioritise route flexibility, reconfirm uplift and bunkering arrangements, and keep travel and site fuel assumptions under active review.

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